



American Trischa Zorn is the most successful Paralympian in history. She won an amazing 41 gold medals in swimming between 1980 and 2004.

The Games

The first Games for disabled athletes were held in Rome, Italy, in 1960. Today, the Paralympics are staged **at the same place** as the Summer and Winter Olympic Games. They are an important part of the world's sporting calendar.

The "Para" in "Paralympics" comes from the Greek word "para," which means "next to," because the Paralympics run alongside the Olympics.

The events

The Paralympics feature more than 20 sports and hundreds of events, including track and field, wheelchair basketball, cycling, swimming, and wheelchair fencing. The athletes range from those who are blind, to those who have lost a limb or use a wheelchair, and many more.

